

IT Security & Infrastructure Guide

[IT Security & Infrastructure Guide](#)
[Revision History](#)
[1. Introduction](#)
[2. Password Policy](#)
[3. Multi-Factor Authentication \(MFA\)](#)
[4. VPN Setup Guide](#)
[5. Email Configuration](#)
[6. Endpoint Security](#)
[7. Device Management](#)
[8. Data Protection](#)
[9. Incident Reporting](#)
[9A. Wi-Fi and Network Access](#)
[9B. Compliance Audits](#)
[10. Internal Contacts](#)
[11. Related Documents](#)
[12. References](#)

IT Security & Infrastructure Guide

Series Tech Ltd. — Internal Use Only

[Company Logo Placeholder — SeriesTech_Logo.png]

Classification: Internal — Restricted **Document Number:** STL-IT-SEC-002 **Version:** 4.1 **Last Updated:** 2026-06-02 **Owner:** Head of Information Technology **Approver:** Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)

Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	2021-11-05	N. Rao (IT)	Initial Password and VPN policy
2.0	2023-02-14	P. Iyer (IT Sec)	Added MFA mandate and Endpoint Security
3.0	2024-08-30	P. Iyer (IT Sec)	Added Device Management and Data Protection sections
4.0	2025-10-11	K. Sharma (IT Sec)	Incident Reporting workflow overhaul
4.1	2026-06-02	K. Sharma (IT Sec)	Updated MFA app requirement, added Security Controls table

1. Introduction

This guide defines the mandatory security controls, infrastructure access procedures, and incident response

expectations for all Series Tech Ltd. employees, contractors, and vendors with access to company systems. It is maintained by the IT Security team and reviewed quarterly.

Note: Non-compliance with this guide may result in suspension of system access and is addressed under the Disciplinary Process defined in the HR Division Knowledge Base (STL-HR-KB-001), Section 6.5.

1.1 Scope

This guide covers all endpoints (laptops, desktops, mobile devices), network access (VPN, Wi-Fi), identity systems (Single Sign-On, MFA), email, and data classification standards used across Engineering, Projects, DevOps, QA, Architecture, and corporate functions.

1.2 Definitions

Term	Definition
MFA	Multi-Factor Authentication
SSO	Single Sign-On, provided via Okta at SeriesTech
VPN	Virtual Private Network, used to access internal systems remotely
Endpoint	Any company-issued or BYOD device connecting to SeriesTech systems
DLP	Data Loss Prevention
PII	Personally Identifiable Information
SOC	Security Operations Center

2. Password Policy

2.1 Password Requirements

All SeriesTech accounts, including HR Connect, Jira, Confluence, GitHub Enterprise, and AWS/Azure consoles, must use passwords meeting the following criteria:

- Minimum 14 characters
- At least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one digit, and one special character
- Must not reuse any of the last 10 passwords
- Must not contain the employee's username, name, or "SeriesTech"

2.2 Password Rotation

Passwords for standard accounts expire every 90 days. Privileged accounts (root, admin, database superuser) expire every 45 days and require a second approver from IT Security to reset.

Warning: Sharing passwords, even temporarily with a colleague for "quick access," is a direct violation of this policy and will be logged as a Moderate violation under the Code of Conduct.

2.3 Password Managers

Employees are provided a license for the approved password manager (1Password Business) upon onboarding. Storing credentials in browser-saved passwords, spreadsheets, or plain text files is prohibited.

3. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

3.1 Mandatory MFA Systems

MFA is mandatory for SSO login, VPN connections, GitHub Enterprise, AWS Console, Azure Portal, and any system holding client data. SeriesTech uses Okta Verify as the primary MFA application; Duo Mobile is supported as a fallback for legacy systems.

3.2 MFA Enrollment Workflow

```
graph TD
    A[New employee receives Okta activation email] --> B[Employee installs Okta Verify on personal or company mobile device]
    B --> C[Employee scans QR code to link account]
    C --> D[IT verifies enrollment status in Okta Admin Console]
    D --> E[Access to SSO-protected systems is unlocked]
```

3.3 Lost Device Procedure

If an MFA-enrolled device is lost or stolen, the employee must immediately contact the IT Helpdesk (it-helpdesk@seriestech.com or extension 4100) to de-register the device and issue a temporary bypass code, valid for 4 hours.

4. VPN Setup Guide

4.1 Supported VPN Client

SeriesTech uses GlobalProtect (Palo Alto Networks) as its standard VPN client for all remote and hybrid employees.

4.2 Installation Steps

1. Download GlobalProtect from the Software Center on your company-issued laptop, or from the IT Self-Service Portal.
2. Launch the client and enter the portal address: `vpn.seriestech.com`.
3. Authenticate using your SSO credentials plus MFA.
4. Once connected, verify connectivity by accessing `intranet.seriestech.com`.

4.3 VPN Access Tiers

Tier	User Group	Access Granted
Standard	All employees	Intranet, HR Connect, Confluence, Jira
Elevated	Engineering, DevOps, QA	Internal repositories, staging environments, CI/CD dashboards
Privileged	DevOps leads, Architecture	Production infrastructure consoles, database bastion hosts

Best Practice: Disconnect VPN when not actively working to reduce load on the concentrator, especially during release weeks described in the Deployment Guide (STL-DEVQA-DEP-008).

5. Email Configuration

5.1 Corporate Email Standards

All employees are issued a @seriestech.com mailbox hosted on Microsoft 365. Email aliases follow the format firstname.lastname@seriestech.com.

5.2 Mobile and Desktop Setup

Outlook is the standard desktop client. Mobile configuration requires the Microsoft Authenticator app for Conditional Access compliance; personal mail apps that do not support modern authentication are blocked at the tenant level.

5.3 Phishing and Spam Handling

Suspicious emails should be reported using the “Report Phishing” button in Outlook, which forwards the message to the SOC for triage. Employees must never click links or open attachments from unrecognized senders claiming to be from IT, HR, or Finance requesting credentials.

6. Endpoint Security

6.1 Required Endpoint Controls

All company-issued endpoints must run CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR agent), full-disk encryption (BitLocker for Windows, FileVault for macOS), and receive OS patches within 14 days of release for critical vulnerabilities.

6.2 Security Controls Table

Control	Applies To	Enforcement Mechanism
Full-Disk Encryption	All laptops	BitLocker/FileVault, enforced via Intune
EDR Agent (CrowdStrike)	All endpoints	Mandatory install via Software Center
Automatic Screen Lock	All endpoints	5-minute inactivity timeout
USB Port Control	Engineering, DevOps, Architecture	Blocked by default, exception via IT ticket
Patch Compliance	All endpoints	Monthly patch Tuesday cycle plus emergency patches
Application Allowlisting	Finance, HR	Restricted to approved software list

6.3 BYOD Policy

Personal devices may access email and Teams only, via Microsoft Intune Mobile Application Management. BYOD devices cannot access source code repositories or production systems.

7. Device Management

7.1 Device Lifecycle

Devices are provisioned through Intune during onboarding (see Organization Structure & Employee Onboarding Guide, STL-ORG-ONB-007, Section on Equipment Allocation) and are re-imaged and reassigned after an employee’s exit, following a mandatory data wipe.

7.2 Device Refresh Cycle

Laptops are refreshed every 3 years for standard roles and every 2 years for Engineering and DevOps roles

running resource-intensive workloads such as local Docker/Kubernetes clusters.

7.3 Loss or Theft

Any lost or stolen device must be reported within 2 hours to IT Security via the Incident Reporting workflow in Section 9. Devices are remotely wiped through Intune upon confirmation of loss.

8. Data Protection

8.1 Data Classification

Classification	Description	Example
Public	Approved for external release	Marketing materials, published blog posts
Internal	For employee use only	This document, internal wikis
Confidential	Sensitive business information	Financial reports, HR records
Restricted	Client data, credentials, PII	Project Alpha client datasets, database credentials

8.2 Data Handling Rules

- Restricted and Confidential data must never be stored on personal devices or personal cloud accounts.
- Data transfers to external parties require a signed Data Sharing Agreement and DLP scan clearance.
- Client data used in RAG pipelines (see Enterprise System Architecture & FAQ, STL-ARCH-SYS-009) must be stored only in approved vector databases (ChromaDB, FAISS) within the corporate Azure/AWS tenant, never in public or personal cloud instances.

8.3 Data Retention

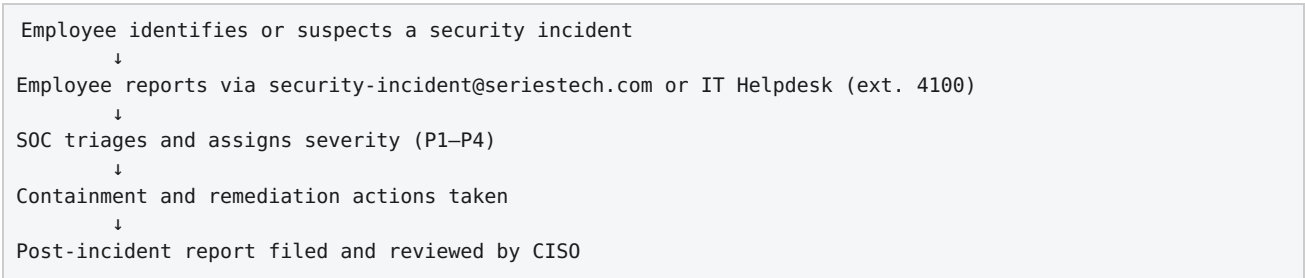
Confidential business records are retained for 7 years. Restricted client data retention follows the specific client contract, defaulting to 3 years post-engagement unless otherwise specified.

9. Incident Reporting

9.1 What Constitutes a Security Incident

Examples include suspected phishing compromise, lost or stolen devices, unauthorized access attempts, malware detection alerts from CrowdStrike, and accidental exposure of Confidential or Restricted data.

9.2 Incident Reporting Workflow



9.3 Severity Matrix

--	--	--

Severity	Definition	Response Time
P1 — Critical	Active breach, production data exposure	15 minutes
P2 — High	Malware detected, credential compromise suspected	1 hour
P3 — Medium	Policy violation without confirmed data exposure	4 hours
P4 — Low	Suspicious email reported, no compromise confirmed	1 business day

Warning: Failure to report a suspected incident within 2 hours of discovery is itself treated as a policy violation, regardless of the outcome of the incident.

9A. Wi-Fi and Network Access

9A.1 Corporate Wireless Networks

Office locations broadcast two SSIDs: `SeriesTech-Corp` for company-issued devices (802.1X certificate-based authentication) and `SeriesTech-Guest` for visitors, isolated at the network layer with no access to internal systems. Personal devices must not connect to `SeriesTech-Corp`.

9A.2 Network Segmentation

Segment	Purpose	Access Control
Corporate LAN	Employee workstations	802.1X, device compliance check via Intune
Server/Production VLAN	Kubernetes nodes, databases	Restricted to DevOps and Architecture via jump host
Guest Network	Visitor internet access	Fully isolated, no internal routing
Lab/Test VLAN	Engineering experimentation	Isolated from Production VLAN, snapshot-based reset weekly

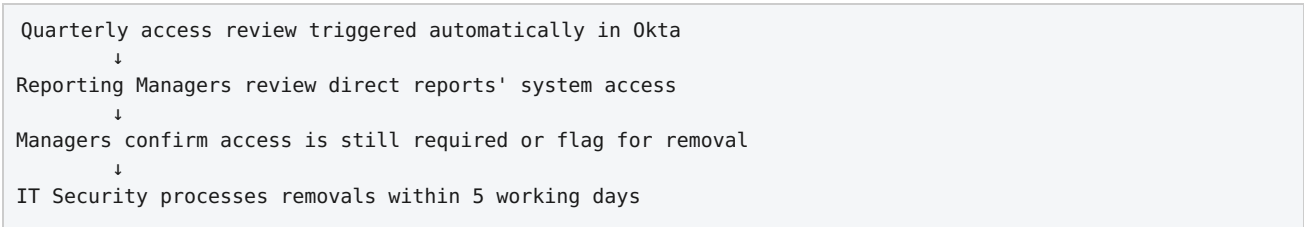
Note: Any request to bridge the Lab/Test VLAN with Production resources must be reviewed by IT Security and the Architecture Review Board jointly, given the risk of accidental exposure of Restricted data described in Section 8.1.

9B. Compliance Audits

9B.1 Audit Cadence

IT Security conducts an internal compliance audit every quarter, covering password policy adherence, MFA enrollment rates, patch compliance, and access review completion. An external audit is conducted annually by a third-party security firm, with findings presented to the CTO and the Board Audit Committee.

9B.2 Access Review Workflow



↓
Audit trail recorded for compliance reporting

Best Practice: Reporting Managers should treat quarterly access reviews as an opportunity to right-size permissions, particularly for employees who have changed roles or projects since the last review, rather than reflexively re-approving all existing access.

9B.3 Vendor and Third-Party Access

Vendors requiring temporary access to SeriesTech systems (for example, a client's IT team validating an on-prem Ollama deployment for Project Alpha) must be provisioned through the Vendor Access Request process, with access automatically expiring after 30 days unless renewed with written justification from the sponsoring department head.

10. Internal Contacts

Purpose	Contact
IT Helpdesk	it-helpdesk@seriestech.com / ext. 4100
Security Incidents	security-incident@seriestech.com
VPN/Network Issues	network-ops@seriestech.com
Access Requests	access-requests@seriestech.com

11. Related Documents

- STL-HR-KB-001 — HR Division Knowledge Base
- STL-ORG-ONB-007 — Organization Structure & Employee Onboarding Guide
- STL-ARCH-SYS-009 — Enterprise System Architecture & FAQ
- STL-DEVQA-DEP-008 — Deployment Guide & QA Testing Guidelines

12. References

- SeriesTech Information Security Policy Framework, v6, Legal & Compliance
- Okta Admin Console Configuration Standards, IT Security, 2026
- CrowdStrike Falcon Deployment Runbook, IT Security internal wiki

Internal Use Only — Series Tech Ltd. © 2026. Unauthorized distribution of this document outside the organization is prohibited.